Table 14.1 MDGs and Vision of Gender Equality

MDGs	*Importance of Gender Equality*
Goal 1: Eradicate extreme poverty and hunger	Addressing Women's health and nutritional issues and giving them access to basic infrastructure facilities will increase economic activity, productivity and well being.
Goal 2: Achieve universal primary education	Addressing women's primary education will help them in greater decision-making in issues related to fertility, public domain, child's education, health and nutritional values.
Goal 3: Promote gender equality and empower women	Addressing the goal of gender equality and empowerment will automatically help in solving gender related problems and bridge gender gap.
Goal 4: Reduce child mortality	Addressing goals of women's education and empowerment will help in lowering child mortality.
Goal 5: Improve maternal health	Addressing goals of women's education, health, nutrition along with empowerment will reduce maternal mortality.
Goal 6: Combat HIV/AIDS, Malaria and other diseases	Economic independence, increased ability to negotiate for safe sex, raising consciousness and awareness about sexual relations will help in preventing HIV/AIDS. Similar consciousness about epidemic diseases can stop their outbreak at a massive scale.
Goal 7: Ensure environmental sustainability	Gender-equitable property and resource ownership policies would enable women to manage them in a sustainable manner.
	Developing global partnership for gender-sensitive development with greater gender equality in the political sphere will lead to higher investments in development cooperation.

[**Source:** Adapted from Grown et el., 2005][10]

Human Development Index (HDI) gave a new dimension to development by considering factors or indicators, other than the